

Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + carboplatin

Lung · NCCP 00568 · version 5

Your medicines

Your treatment schedule

A picture of side effects

Numbers connect each symptom box to the relevant anatomical area. Tell your team about new or worsening symptoms.

Pembrolizumab · immune effects

Pemetrexed / carboplatin · chemotherapy

1 Hormones / brain

Pembrolizumab

Unusual tiredness, dizziness, headache, thirst or passing more urine.

2 Lungs

Pembrolizumab

New cough or breathlessness: report promptly. Infection, cancer or a clot can cause similar symptoms.

3 Heart

Pembrolizumab

Chest pain, racing heartbeat or fainting needs urgent assessment.

4 Liver

Pembrolizumab

Yellow eyes or skin, dark urine or changes in blood tests.

5 Kidneys

Pemetrexed / pembrolizumab

Kidney function is monitored. Report less urine or new swelling.

6 Bowel

Pembrolizumab / chemotherapy

New diarrhoea, persistent vomiting or severe tummy pain: contact your team.

7 Skin / nerves

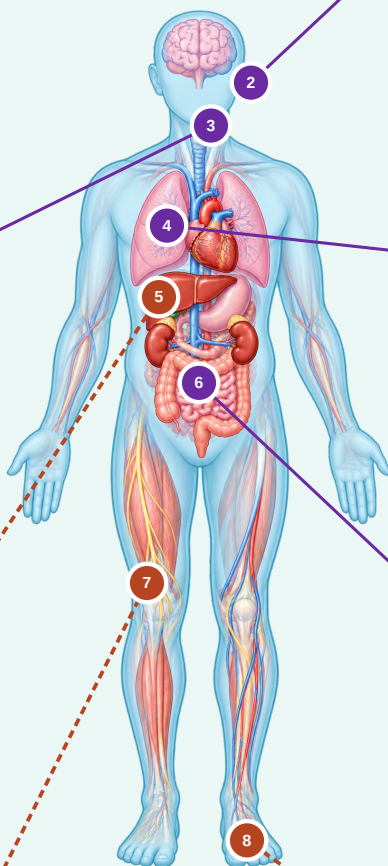
Pembrolizumab / chemotherapy

Spreading rash, blisters, weakness or new numbness should be reported.

8 Blood / infection

Pemetrexed / carboplatin

Fever, shivers or suddenly feeling unwell: contact oncology immediately.



Selected effects only: the same symptom can have more than one cause, and not every possible side effect is shown.

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TREATMENT JOURNEY

Before cycle 1 Blood tests, kidney function, glucose and thyroid testing; folic acid and vitamin B12 support for pemetrexed.	Cycles 1-4 · day 1 Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed + carboplatin every 21 days.	Between cycles Watch for immune symptoms and chemotherapy effects; they can occur at any time.	After cycle 4 Carboplatin stops if the plan is followed and disease/toxicity allow.	Maintenance Pembrolizumab + pemetrexed every 21 days until progression or unacceptable toxicity, according to the treatment plan.
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IMPORTANT MEDICINE-SPECIFIC EFFECTS

Pembrolizumab - immune effects

- Immune inflammation: lungs, bowel, liver, hormone glands, kidneys, skin, heart, nerves or muscles.
- New immune symptoms can begin during treatment or after treatment has stopped.

Pemetrexed

- Low blood counts can increase infection, anaemia or bruising risk.
- Mouth/gut inflammation and skin rash can occur.
- Kidney function can deteriorate and is monitored.

Carboplatin

- Low blood counts, especially neutrophils and platelets, can occur.
- Allergic infusion reactions can occur, particularly after repeated exposure.
- Nausea and vomiting may occur despite preventative medicines.

OTHER / SHARED TREATMENT EFFECTS

The anatomy page highlights important symptom patterns for this exact regimen, but it cannot show every possible effect. Fatigue, nausea, appetite change, mouth/bowel symptoms or blood-count changes may occur depending on the medicines used. Report new or worsening symptoms even if they are not listed.

Monitoring / medicines

- Take folic acid exactly as prescribed while on pemetrexed and for the required period after it stops.
- Vitamin B12 is given before pemetrexed and then at protocol-defined intervals.
- Blood count, kidney/liver profile and glucose are checked before each cycle; thyroid tests are repeated during treatment.

Bring / track

- Your current medicines, including non-prescription products.
- A note of new symptoms, when they started and what they stopped you doing.
- Any temperature, blood-pressure or bowel-count readings your team asked you to record.
- Questions about the purpose of treatment, scan/review timing or changes to the plan.

WHEN TO CALL - DO NOT WAIT FOR THE NEXT APPOINTMENT

Call oncology urgently for fever, new breathlessness, persistent diarrhoea, jaundice, severe rash, marked weakness, confusion or any rapidly worsening symptom. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain: call 112/999. If your team has given you different local thresholds or emergency instructions, follow those instructions.

Consent discussion support

Use the approved consent process to document treatment aim, expected benefit, material risks, alternatives, questions and the patient's decision.

Scan to open the regimen-specific patient portal

<https://sactcheck.com/patient/00568/>

Official NCCP 00568 v5

SACTCheck v0.81.1 · patient information prototype for clinical review. Follow your oncology team and local emergency instructions.

